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Information processing apparatus, information processing method, and recording medium

Abstract

An information processing apparatus includes a memory and at least one processor. The memory stores a learned model having learned correlation between character strings included in a search history of words and/or phrases. The processor inputs information of a search history of words and/or phrases by a target user to the learned model. The processor creates a word and/or a phrase for learning by the target user.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION

(1) This application is based upon and claims the benefit of priority from prior Japanese Patent Application No. 2021-146184, filed Sep. 8, 2021, the entire contents of which are incorporated

herein by reference.

FIELD

(2) The disclosure relates to an information processing apparatus, an information processing method, and a recording medium.

BACKGROUND

(3) In prior art, electronic dictionaries include electronic dictionaries having a function of a vocabulary notebook storing words and/or phrases, such as words and/or idioms, searched by the users, and presenting them to the users. The electronic dictionaries having a function of a vocabulary notebook include electronic dictionaries having a test function of setting the user a problem of words or the like as a testing question (for example, Japanese Patent Application Publication No. 2007-219824).

SUMMARY

(4) An information processing apparatus according to an aspect, includes a memory and at least one processor. The memory stores a learned model having learned correlation between character strings included in a search history of words and/or phrases. The processor inputs information of a search history of words and/or phrases by a target user to the learned model. The processor creates a word and/or a phrase for learning by the target user.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a diagram showing an example of configuration of a system according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(2) FIG. 2A is a conceptual diagram of a question creating model using an RNN.

(3) FIG. 2B is a diagram illustrating a question creating model acquired by developing the RNN block illustrated in FIG. 2A.

(4) FIG. 3 is a flowchart showing operations of an electronic dictionary.

(5) FIG. 4 is a flowchart showing operations of a server.

(6) FIG. 5 is a diagram showing an example of sentences which the user has searched for words using the electronic dictionary.

(7) FIG. 6 is a diagram showing relation between data input to the question creating model and teacher data.

(8) FIG. 7 is a diagram showing relation between a word string of a search history input to the question creating model and a created word.

(9) FIG. 8 is a flowchart showing test processing in the electronic dictionary.

(10) FIG. 9 is a diagram showing an example of presenting a test question.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(11) An embodiment of the present disclosure will be explained hereinafter with reference to drawings. FIG. 1 is a diagram showing an example of configuration of a system 1 according to an embodiment of the present disclosure. A system 1 includes a server 10 and an electronic dictionary 20. The server 10 and the electronic dictionary 20 are connected to be communicatable via a network 30. The network 30 is, for example, the Internet. FIG. 1 illustrates only one electronic dictionary 20, but the number of electronic dictionaries 20 is not limited to one. Specifically, two or more electronic dictionaries 20 may be included.

(12) The server 10 is an information processing apparatus including a processor 11, a ROM 12, a RAM 13, a storage 14, and a communication module 15. These units are mutually connected via a system bus 16.

(13) The processor 11 is a processor controlling various operations of the server 10. The processor 11 may be an integrated circuit including a CPU (Central Processing Unit) and the like. As the

processor **11**, a processor other than a CPU may be used. Examples of the processor include an ASIC (Application Specific Integrated circuit), a FPGA (Field Programmable Gate Array), and a GPU (Graphic Processing Unit).

(14) The ROM **12** records information used for operations of the processor **11** and the like. The RAM **13** is a main storage device for operations of the processor **11** and the like.

(15) The storage **14** stores various programs, such as a server control program used in the processor **11** and an arithmetic program to execute various arithmetic operations, and parameters and the like. The programs includes a question creating program **141**. The question creating program **141** serving as an information processing program is a program creating a question in accordance with a user's search history for words and/or phrases in the electronic dictionary **20**. The processor **11** can operate as a question creating unit by executing processing in accordance with the question creating program **141** stored in the storage **14**. The question creating unit may be achieved with a dedicated circuit achieving similar operations. For example, the user in the embodiment is supposed to be a student. As a matter of course, the user may be a person other than a student.

(16) The storage **14** also stores a dictionary content **142**. The dictionary content **142** is content data, such as an English-Japanese dictionary and a Japanese-English dictionary, storing words and/or phrases, in association with pronunciation and meaning thereof. The dictionary content **142** is not limited to English dictionaries. The dictionary content **142** may be content data of dictionaries of a language other than English.

(17) The storage **14** also stores user information **143** and a search history **144**. The user information **143** is information to identify the user of the electronic dictionary **20**. The user information may include, for example, a user's ID, an ID of the electronic dictionary **20**, and information indicating the attribute of the user, such as the user's age, and the school's name and the class name to which the user belongs. The search history **144** is information of a history of words and the like for which the user has searched using the electronic dictionary **20**. The search history **144** is collected, for example, whenever the electronic dictionary **20** is powered off.

(18) The storage **14** also stores a question creating model **145**. The question creating model **145** is a learned machine learning model configured to receive a character string acquired from the user's search history **144** and create a new character string relating to the input character string. The character string input or created in the embodiment is formed of one or more characters and may include a word or a phrase. The question creating model **145** in the embodiment is formed of, for example, a recurrent neural network (RNN).

(19) FIG. 2A is a conceptual diagram of the question creating model **145** using a RNN. FIG. 2A illustrates a state of the question creating model **145** at time t . As illustrated in FIG. 2A, the question creating model **145** includes an input layer **1451**, an intermediate layer **1452**, and an output layer **1453**.

(20) The input layer **1451** converts the character string input as the search history **144** into a vector quantity, and outputs a character string vector acquired by conversion to the intermediate layer **1452**. The input character string is divided into, for example, words, and a space is included between the adjacent words.

(21) The intermediate layer **1452** is an RNN block. The RNN block receives a character string vector from the input layer **1451**, and receives an output of the RNN block at the previous time. The RNN block inputs the input from the input layer **1451** and the output of the RNN block at the previous time to a preset function f , and outputs output of the function f as a RNN output of the current time. FIG. 2B is a diagram illustrating a question creating model **145** acquired by developing the RNN block illustrated in FIG. 2A. As illustrated in FIG. 2B, the RNN block at the time t outputs a RNN output (t) on the basis of the input from the input layer at the time t and the RNN output ($t-1$) at time $t-1$. As illustrated in FIG. 2B, the RNN output at each time reflects the state of the RNN output before the time. For this reason, the RNN output (t) at the time t reflects the state of the RNN outputs from the time 1 to the time t . In this manner, the intermediate layer

1452 outputs a RNN output reflecting time-series input change.

(22) The output layer **1453** converts the RNN output from the intermediate layer into a value of distribution of appearance probability of the character string using a Softmax function or the like. For example, if the question creating model **145** is configured to output one alphanumeric character for each input of the search history **144** for English words, the output layer **1453** outputs a probability of appearance of each character string supposed to appear, such as an alphabet, a numerical character, a space, and a symbol such as “&”.

(23) The question creating model **145** may be provided for each of users, for each age of users, for each school year or class, or may be provided without these discriminations.

(24) The communication module **15** includes a circuit to communicate with an external communication network, such as the network **30**.

(25) The electronic dictionary **20** includes a processor **21**, a ROM **22**, a RAM **23**, a storage **24**, an input device **25**, a display **26**, and a communication module **27**. These units are mutually connected via a system bus **28**. The electronic dictionary **20** may be an electronic apparatus, such as a personal computer (PC), a tablet terminal, and a smartphone in which an electronic dictionary application is installed.

(26) The processor **21** is a processor controlling various operations of the electronic dictionary **20**. The processor **21** may be an integrated circuit including a CPU and the like. As the processor **21**, a processor other than a CPU may be used.

(27) The ROM **22** records a starting program for the electronic dictionary **20** and the like. The RAM **23** is a main storage device for the processor **21**.

(28) The storage **24** stores various programs, such as electronic dictionary control program used in the processor **21**, and parameters. The processor **21** controls operations of the electronic dictionary **20** by executing various programs in accordance with an input signal from the input device **25** or the like. The various programs include, for example, a dictionary program **241** and a test program **242**. The dictionary program **241** is a program to execute a series of processes of searching the dictionary content **243** on the basis of a user's input and presenting the search result to the user. The test program **242** is a program to execute a series of processes relating to a test to inquire of the user the meaning and the pronunciation and the like of a word.

(29) The storage **24** also stores the dictionary content **243**. The dictionary content **243** is content data, such as an English-Japanese dictionary and a Japanese-English dictionary, storing words and/or phrases, in association with pronunciation and meaning thereof. The dictionary content **243** is not limited to English dictionaries. The dictionary content **243** may be content data of dictionaries of a language other than English. The dictionary content **243** may be the same as the dictionary content **142** of the server **10**, or may include part of data of the dictionary content **142**.

(30) The input device **25** includes input keys and a touch panel and the like. The input device **25** may also include a voice input device, such as a microphone. In accordance with a user's operation via the input device **25**, a signal indicating details of the user's operation is input to the processor **21** via the system bus **28**.

(31) The display **26** is a liquid crystal display or an organic EL display or the like. The display **26** may be provided as one unitary piece with the electronic dictionary **20**, or separately from the electronic dictionary **20**. Various images are displayed on the display **26**.

(32) The communication module **27** includes a circuit to communicate with an external communication network, such as the network **30**.

(33) The following is an explanation of operations of the system **1**. FIG. **3** is a flowchart showing operations of the electronic dictionary **20**. The process in FIG. **3** is started if, for example, the electronic dictionary **20** is powered on.

(34) At Step **S1**, the processor **21** of the electronic dictionary **20** determines whether to execute search. For example, if the user inputs a character string, such as a word, to a search box displayed on the display **26** after the electronic dictionary **20** starts to operate, the electronic dictionary **20**

determines to execute search. If it is determined at Step S1 to execute search, the processing proceeds to Step S2. If it is determined at Step S1 to execute no search, the processing proceeds to Step S9.

(35) At Step S2, the processor 21 refers to the dictionary content 243 on the basis of the input character string, and searches for a word or the like partially matching the input character string.

(36) At Step S3, the processor 21 determines whether any corresponding word or the like exists as a result of search. If it is determined at Step S3 that any corresponding word or the like exists, the processing proceeds to Step S4. If it is determined at Step S3 that no corresponding word or the like exists, the processing proceeds to Step S6.

(37) At Step S4, the processor 21 displays information of the dictionary content 243 relating to the corresponding word as a search result. For example, the processor 21 displays information, such as the meaning and the pronunciation of the word on the display 26. For example, if a plurality of corresponding words or the like exist, the processor 21 may display a list of the corresponding words or the like on the display 26, receive subsequent user's selection of the word or the like, and display information, such as the meaning and the pronunciation of the selected word, on the display 26.

(38) At Step S5, the processor 21 records information of the character string input in the search on the storage 24 or the like as a search history. Thereafter, the processing proceeds to Step S7.

(39) At Step S6, the processor 21 executes error display on the display 26. The error display includes, for example, display of a message to notify the user that no corresponding words exist. After the error display, the processing proceeds to Step S7.

(40) At Step S7, the processor 21 determines whether to power off the electronic dictionary 20. For example, if a predetermined period of time for which no operations are executed passes or the power switch is turned off, it is determined to power off the electronic dictionary 20.

(41) If it is determined at Step S7 to power off the electronic dictionary 20, the processing proceeds to Step S8. If it is determined at Step S7 not to power off the electronic dictionary 20, the processing returns to Step S1.

(42) At Step S8, the processor 21 transmits information of the search history recorded on the storage 24 to the server 10 together with the user information using the communication module 27. Thereafter, the processor 21 powers off the electronic dictionary 20 to finish the processing in FIG. 3. Transmission of information of the search history is not limited to execution directly before power off. Transmission of information of the search history may be executed in a specific time period, such as the night of each day.

(43) At Step S9, the processor 21 determines whether to execute a test. For example, if the operating mode of the electronic dictionary 20 is set to the test mode by the user, it is determined to execute a test. As another example, it may be automatically determined to execute a test, if the electronic dictionary 20 is powered on. If it is determined at Step S9 to execute a test, the processing proceeds to Step S10. If it is determined at Step S9 to execute no test, the processing proceeds to Step S7.

(44) At Step S10, the processor 21 executes test processing. After execution of the test processing, the processing proceeds to Step S7. The test processing will be explained later.

(45) FIG. 4 is a flowchart showing operations of the server 10. The processing in FIG. 4 is intermittently executed during the operation of the server 10.

(46) At Step S101, the processor 11 of the server 10 determines whether to execute learning of the question creating model 145. For example, it is determined to execute learning for each predetermined period of time, such as the night of each day. If it is determined at Step S101 to execute learning, the processing proceeds to Step S102. If it is determined at Step S101 to execute no learning, the processing proceeds to Step S103.

(47) At Step S102, the processor 11 executes learning of the question creating model 145. After execution of the learning, the processing proceeds to Step S103.

(48) The following is an explanation of learning of the question creating model **145** in the embodiment with a specific example. The following example illustrates learning of the question creating model **145** for English words.

(49) For example, suppose that the user of the electronic dictionary **20** searches for the meanings of the words indicated with frames in sentences **301** of FIG. 5 using the electronic dictionary **20**. Thereafter, if the electronic dictionary **20** is powered off, information of a search history **302** is transmitted to the server **10** together with the user information. The search history **302** is formed of a word string “construct hectic overworking interaction confine wellbeing instance harm reactive proactive” in which the searched English words are arranged in a line. The search history **302** also includes each of spaces between adjacent words as a character. The word string transmitted as the search history **302** in FIG. 5 is a search history of words in the same sentences. In this case, the searched words are considered to have correlation of a certain degree. For example, in the search history **302** in FIG. 5, the words “active” and “proactive” have relation of antonyms. The question creating model **145** generates a character string of words or the like by learning the correlation between the searched words as described above.

(50) FIG. 6 is a diagram showing relation between data input to the question creating model **145** and teacher data. In this example, a character string formed of 30 characters including spaces is input to the question creating model **145**. The question creating model **145** predicts the next character of the input character string.

(51) In this case, first, the processor **11** inputs the top 30 characters, that is, “construct hectic overworking i” of the word string “construct hectic overworking interaction confine wellbeing instance harm reactive proactive” received as the search history **302** to the question creating model **145**. By contrast, the processor **11** inputs the next character “n” of the input 30 characters as the teacher data.

(52) Thereafter, the processor **11** inputs the 30 characters “struct hectic overworking inte” acquired by shifting the range from the previous input characters “construct hectic overworking i” by a predetermined number of characters, for example, three characters, to the question creating model **145**. By contrast, the processor **11** inputs the next character “r” of the input 30 characters as the teacher data.

(53) Thereafter, the processor **11** inputs all the characters received as the search history **302**, in the same manner. Lastly, the processor **11** inputs a space as the teacher data.

(54) Whenever a character string is input, the question creating model **145** executes prediction using the input character string and the previous RNN output. For example, the question creating model **145** predicts the prediction probability indicating the appearance probability for each supposed character string, for example, 0.2 as the probability of “a”, 0.1 as the probability of “b”, 0.02 as the probability of “z”, and 0.05 as the probability of a space. The question creating model **145** regulates a weight coefficient or the like used for a function f in the RNN block to decrease a difference between the prediction result and the teacher data. Learning is executed by repeating such processing.

(55) As described above, the question creating model **145** inputs a partial character string of the character string based on the search history, and regulates the weight coefficient or the like to output a partial character string of a different part in the character string of the search history. Specifically, the question creating model **145** learns correlation between character strings included in the search history.

(56) In the example of FIG. 6, each of the character strings is input to the question creating model **145** while the range thereof is shifted by three characters. By contrast, the number of shifted characters is not limited to three. For example, each of the character strings may be input to the question creating model **145** while the range thereof is shifted by one character or two characters, or by four or more characters. Learning of the question creating model **145** can be executed with higher accuracy as the number of shifted characters decreases. By contrast, with decrease in the

number of shifted characters, learning requires much time. Generally, most English words are formed of three or more characters. For this reason, with the number of shifted characters of three, the structure easily extracts characteristics of the same degree as those in the case where the number of shifted character is one, and achieves the learning accuracy not largely different from that in the case where the number of shifted character is one. Accordingly, in the present embodiment, the number of shifted characters is set to three.

(57) In addition, as described above, the question creating model **145** may be provided for each of users, for each age of users, or for each school year or class of the school the users attend. In these cases, the processor **11** selects information to be input to the question creating model **145** on the basis of the user information. For example, if the question creating model **145** is provided for each of users, the processor **11** executes learning of the question creating model **145** only with information of the search history of the same user on the basis of the user information. In the same manner, if the question creating model **145** is provided for each age of users, the processor **11** executes learning of the question creating model **145** only with information of the search histories of users of the same age on the basis of the user information.

(58) FIG. **4** will be explained again hereinafter. At Step **S103**, the processor **11** determines whether any inquiry for a test question has been received from the electronic dictionary **20**. As explained later, in the test processing in the electronic dictionary **20**, the electronic dictionary **20** issues an inquiry for a test question to the server **10**. At Step **S103**, it is determined whether any inquiry has been received. If it is determined at Step **S103** that an inquiry has been received, the processing proceeds to Step **S104**. If it is determined at Step **S103** that no inquiry has been received, the processing returns to Step **S101**.

(59) At Step **S104**, the processor **11** acquires, from the storage **14**, the latest search history of the user of the electronic dictionary **20** from which the inquiry has been received, for example, the search history collected last night.

(60) At Step **S105**, the processor **11** inputs the acquired search history to the question creating model **145** to create a word for a test question.

(61) The following is an explanation of creation of a word using the question creating model **145** in the embodiment with a specific example. FIG. **7** is a diagram showing relation between a word string of the search history input to the question creating model **145** and a created word.

(62) For example, suppose that the latest search history is formed of five words “trial”, “ocean”, “pear”, “palm”, and “approachable”. In this case, the processor **11** creates a word string **401** by arranging the five words in a line with a space therebetween. The processor **11** inputs the word string **401** to the question creating model **145**. In response to it, the question creating model **145** predicts the next character subsequent to the character string “trial ocean pear palm approachable” including spaces.

(63) First, the processor **11** inputs the 35 characters “trial ocean pear palm approachable” including spaces to the question creating model **145**. The question creating model **145** predicts the prediction probability of each of character strings, such as an alphabet, a numerical character, a space, and a symbol “&” and the like that can appear subsequently to the input “trial ocean pear palm approachable”.

(64) Thereafter, the processor **11** inputs the character string “rial ocean pear palm approachable s” including the character “s” starting from the second character of the word string **401** and having the highest prediction probability in the first prediction to the question creating model **145**. The question creating model **145** predicts the prediction probability of each of character strings, such as an alphabet, a numerical character, a space, and a symbol “&” and the like that can appear subsequently to the input “rial ocean pear palm approachable s”.

(65) The processor **11** repeats input of the character string in the same manner thereafter, and finishes prediction temporarily if the prediction probability of a space becomes highest. In this operation, the processor **11** extracts previous characters having high prediction probabilities if the

prediction is finished successively from the head, and creates a character string acquired by arranging the extracted characters as a word. For example, in the example in FIG. 7, a space appears as a predicted character at the eighth input “cean pear palm approachable survive”. The character string “survive” being the character string **402** before the space is a word created with the question creating model **145**.

(66) A plurality of words can be created by repeating the same processing even after the space appears. In this manner, not only words but also phrases may be created. In experiments executed by the inventors, the following word string was acquired as an example: “cognize, stand seem sure experientially strange according contriver tempt allotrope somehow simultaneon desirably seem considerabt absent considerabh support make belong master specific export bound seat product should recognize, present strong reabuer care sure come tend distally complementizer seem make profession”. Although the string includes some words that do not exist as English words, they are sorted in the following step.

(67) FIG. 4 will be explained again hereinafter. At Step **S106**, the processor **11** determines whether the created word is a word included in the dictionary content **142**. Specifically, words that do not exist as English words or words that are not included in the dictionary content **142** are not adopted as test questions. If it is determined at Step **S106** that the created word is not included in the dictionary content **142**, the processing returns to Step **S105**. As described above, because different words are created by repeating processing even after a space appears, creation of a word is repeatedly executed until a word included in the dictionary content **142** is created. If word creation is executed again, the processor **11** may extract characters from the head such that a word included in the dictionary content **142** is created, on the basis of the previous prediction result. Specifically, the structure may adopt a method of recording the appearance probability of each of characters in the previous prediction, and combining characters having relatively high probabilities, such as the second place and the third place, to create a word included in the dictionary content **142**. If it is determined at Step **S106** that the created word is included in the dictionary content **142**, the processing proceeds to Step **S107**. At Step **S106**, it may also be determined whether the created word is a word for which the user searched in the past predetermined time period, in addition to determination as to whether the created word is included in the dictionary content **142**. The processing may proceed to Step **S107**, if the created word is included in the dictionary content **142** but not a word for which the user searched in the past predetermined time period.

(68) At Step **S107**, the processor **11** transmits the search history used for creation of a test question and a test question including the created word to the electronic dictionary **20** that has issued the inquiry. Thereafter, the processing returns to Step **S101**. The test question is, for example, a question inquiring the meaning and/or the pronunciation of a word or a phrase, and includes a question and an answer to it. Whether the question is a question inquiring the meaning or a question inquiring the pronunciation of the word may be determined at random or designated in advance by the user of the electronic dictionary **20** or the like.

(69) FIG. 8 is a flowchart showing test processing in the electronic dictionary **20**. At Step **S201**, the processor **21** issues an inquiry for a test question to the server **10**.

(70) At Step **S202**, the processor **21** determines whether a test question has been received from the server **10**. If it is determined at Step **S202** that a test question has been received, the processing proceeds to Step **S203**. If it is determined at Step **S202** that no test question has been received, the processing proceeds to Step **S206**.

(71) At Step **S203**, the processor **21** presents a test question to the user. FIG. 9 is a diagram showing an example of presenting a test question. The example of FIG. 9 displays a list **261** of words of the search history of the previous day used for creation of the test question. In addition, in the example of FIG. 9, a question **262** is presented as the test question. The question **262** inquires the meaning of the created word “survive”. In response to presentation of such a question, the user inputs an answer using the input device **25**.

(72) At Step **S204**, the processor **21** determines whether any answer from the user has been received. At Step **S204**, the processor **21** stands by for processing until it is determined that an answer from the user is received. If it is determined at Step **S204** that an answer from the user has been received, the processing proceeds to Step **S205**.

(73) At Step **S205**, the processor **21** compares the answer from the user with the correct answer of the question, and presents a result indicating whether the user's answer to the question is correct or wrong to the user. Thereafter, the processing proceeds to Step **S206**.

(74) At Step **S206**, the processor **21** determines whether the user has commanded to execute a test. If it is determined at Step **S206** that the user has commanded to execute a test, the processing proceeds to Step **S207**. If it is determined at Step **S206** that the user has not commanded to execute a test, the processing proceeds to Step **S209**.

(75) At Step **S207**, the processor **21** creates a test question. For example, the processor **21** selects a word from the dictionary content **142**, and creates a question to inquire the meaning and/or the pronunciation of the selected word. Whether the question is a question inquiring the meaning or a question inquiring the pronunciation of the word may be determined at random or designated in advance by the user of the electronic dictionary **20** or the like. If the word is selected, the processor **21** may select the word for which the user searched in the past or the word for which the user did not search in the past from the words included in the dictionary content **142**.

(76) At Step **S208**, the processor **21** presents the test question to the user. Thereafter, the processing returns to Step **S204**. Presentation of the test question at Step **S208** may basically be executed according to FIG. **9**. However, display of the list **261** of words of the search history of the previous day may be omitted.

(77) At Step **S209**, the processor **21** determines whether to finish the test. For example, if the user sets the operating mode of the electronic dictionary **20** to a mode other than the test mode, it is determined to finish the test. If it is determined at Step **S209** to finish the test, the processor **21** finishes the processing in FIG. **8**. If it is determined at Step **S209** not to finish the test, the processing returns to Step **S206**.

(78) As described above, according to the embodiment, a test question (words and/or phrases for user's study) on the basis of the learning result of the search history of the electronic dictionary **20** (electronic apparatus having a search function) of the user. Because search is executed in time series, the searched words are considered to have correlation of a certain degree. Because the test question is created on the basis of such correlation, a word or a phrase that may be related to the words or the phrases searched for by the user is easily presented as the test question. This structure is expected to effectively improve the user's vocabulary. In addition, a test question is created also on the basis of search histories of a plurality of users. This structure enhances the possibility that a new word or a phrase that may be related to the words or the phrases searched for by the user is presented as the test question. This structure is further expected to effectively improve the user's vocabulary.

(79) Specifically, information of the target user's search history of words and/or phrases is input to the learned model having learned correlation between character strings included in the search history of words and/or phrases to create a word and/or a phrase for learning by the target user. This structure enables the target user to learn vocabulary more effectively.

(80) In addition, the learned model can learn correlation between character strings included in the search histories of the electronic dictionary by a plurality of users included users other than the target user. This structure enables more effective determination of a word and/or a phrase for learning by the target user, also with reference to search histories of users other than the target user.

(81) In addition, the learned model has learned time series of a plurality of character strings included in the search history. With this structure, by inputting the search histories by the target user to the learned model in a time-series manner, a word or a phrase that is not included in the input search histories may be output in a time-series manner. This structure enables the user to

learn a new word or a phrase that is correlated in a time-series manner but has not been searched by the target user.

(82) In addition, in the embodiment, learning of the question creating model can be executed for each of users, for each age of users, or each attribute of users, in consideration of the user information. This structure enables creation of a test question close to the current learning capacity of the user.

(83) Specifically, the learned model has learned search histories by users having the attribute for each attribute of users, and is configured to create a word or a phrase for learning by the target user on the basis of learning results of search histories of other users having the same attribute as the attribute of the target user. This structure enables more effective learning of words and/or phrases on the basis of search histories of other users having attribute similar to the attribute of the target user.

(84) Modification

(85) A modification of the embodiment will be explained hereinafter. In the embodiment, a RNN is used as the question creating model **145**. This is because the search history includes information of arrangement of words in time series, and learning with a RNN is suitable. By contrast, RNNs have various derived models, such as a long short-term memory (LSTM). In the embodiment, various derived models of an RNN may be used. For example, a LSTM enables proper learning even if the character string included in the search history is very long. As another example, a convolutional neural network (CNN) or the like may be used instead of a RNN. Specifically, the question creating model **145** may be any machine learning model configured to create a new word or a phrase, with the search history of the user's dictionary used as an input.

(86) In addition, in the embodiment, the electronic dictionary **20** is capable of communicating. However, some types of electronic dictionaries are not capable of communicating. In this case, for example, the electronic dictionary **20** may transmit the search history via a terminal, such as a smartphone. For example, the electronic dictionary **20** may have a structure in which a two-dimensional code including the search history and the user information is displayed on the display **26** if the electronic dictionary **20** is powered off, the two-dimensional code displayed on the display **26** is read by the user using a smartphone or the like, and the information read using the smartphone is transmitted to the server **10**. In this case, the test question created in the server **10** may be displayed on the smartphone or the like. With this structure, the technique of the embodiment may also be applicable to electronic dictionaries having no communication function.

(87) The embodiment illustrates creation of a test question of English as an example. The technique of the embodiment may also be applicable to creation of test questions of languages other than English.

(88) The present invention is not limited to the embodiment described above, but various modifications are possible at the implementation stage within a range not departing from the gist of the invention. Embodiments may be carried out in proper combinations as long as possible, and effects of the combinations are acquired in these cases. The embodiment described above includes inventions of various stages, and various inventions may be extracted by appropriate combinations of a plurality of disclosed constituent elements. For example, even if some constituent elements are removed from all the constituent elements disclosed in the embodiment, the structure acquired by removing the constituent elements can be extracted as the invention, as long as the problem stated in the section of the problem to be solved by the invention can be solved and the effects stated in the section of the effects of the invention are acquired.

Claims

1. An information processing apparatus comprising: a memory storing a learned model having learned correlation between character strings included in a search history of words and/or phrases;

and at least one processor inputting information of a search history of words and/or phrases by a target user to the learned model and creating a word and/or a phrase for learning by the target user, wherein: the learned model learns a time series of a plurality of character strings included in the search history; the at least one processor inputs search histories by the target user to the learned model in a time-series manner to output a word and/or a phrase that is not included in the input search histories in a time-series manner; the learned model is a recurrent neural network (RNN) learning correlation between character strings of the time series included in the search history; the learned model includes an input layer, an intermediate layer, and an output layer; the input layer converts a character string input as the search history into a vector quantity, and outputs a character string vector acquired by conversion to the intermediate layer; the intermediate layer is an RNN block which: receives the character string vector from the input layer and receives a previous output of the RNN block of a previous time, inputs the character string vector from the input layer and the previous output of the RNN block to a preset function f , and outputs output of the function f as a current RNN output of a current time, whereby the intermediate layer outputs an RNN output reflecting time-series input change; the output layer converts the RNN output from the intermediate layer into a value of distribution of appearance probability of a character based on the input character string; the processor creates the word and/or phrase by combining characters based on the value of distribution of appearance probability of each character, determines whether the created word and/or phrase is included in dictionary content stored in the memory, and controls an output device to output the created word and/or phrase determined to be included in the dictionary content stored in the memory, wherein the processor executes creation of a word and/or phrase again if it is determined that the created word and/or phrase is not included in the dictionary content stored in the memory; and in executing learning, the at least one processor (a) inputs to the learned model a partial character string of the character string based on the search history, the partial character string including a predetermined amount of characters, and (b) inputs a next character in the character string as teacher data, and (c) the model predicts the appearance probability for each supposed character string, and (d) regulates a parameter for the function f in the RNN block to decrease a difference between the prediction result and the teacher data, wherein learning is performed by repeatedly executing (a)-(d), wherein, for each subsequent execution of (a)-(d), the at least one processor inputs, as the partial character string, a partial character string obtained by shifting a range of the character string by a predetermined number of characters to obtain a new partial character string overlapping in part with the previous partial character string.

2. The information processing apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the learned model has learned correlation between character strings included in search histories of an electronic apparatus by a plurality of users including users other than the target user.

3. The information processing apparatus according to claim 2, further comprising: a communication module comprising a circuit and transmitting the created word and/or the phrase to the electronic apparatus used by the target user.

4. The information processing apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the learned model has learned search histories by users having an attribute for each of attributes of users, and creates a word and/or a phrase for learning by the target user on a basis of learning results of search histories of other users having the attribute equal to the attribute of the target user.

5. The information processing apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the at least one processor inputs the character string included in the search history as a character string including a space between words.

6. The information processing apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the at least one processor causes the learned model to execute learning on a basis of user information indicating an attribute of the user.

7. An information processing method comprising: inputting, by a computer of an information processing apparatus storing a learned model having learned correlation between character strings

included in a search history of words and/or phrases, information of a search history of words and/or phrases by a target user to the learned model and creating a word and/or a phrase for learning by the target user, wherein: the learned model learns a time series of a plurality of character strings included in the search history; the method further comprises inputting, by the computer, search histories by the target user to the learned model in a time-series manner to output a word and/or a phrase that is not included in the input search histories in a time-series manner; the learned model is a recurrent neural network (RNN) learning correlation between character strings of the time series included in the search history; the learned model includes an input layer, an intermediate layer, and an output layer; the input layer converts a character string input as the search history into a vector quantity, and outputs a character string vector acquired by conversion to the intermediate layer; the intermediate layer is an RNN block which: receives the character string vector from the input layer and receives a previous output of the RNN block of a previous time, inputs the character string vector from the input layer and the previous output of the RNN block to a preset function f , and outputs output of the function f as a current RNN output of a current time, whereby the intermediate layer outputs an RNN output reflecting time-series input change; the output layer converts the RNN output from the intermediate layer into a value of distribution of appearance probability of a character based on the input character string; the method further comprises creating, by the computer, the word and/or phrase by combining characters based on the value of distribution of appearance probability of each character, determining whether the created word and/or phrase is included in dictionary content stored in the memory, and controlling an output device to output the created word and/or phrase determined to be included in the dictionary content stored in the memory, and creating a word and/or phrase again if it is determined that the created word and/or phrase is not included in the dictionary content stored in the memory; and the method further comprises executing learning, wherein, in said executing learning, the computer (a) inputs to the learned model a partial character string of the character string based on the search history, the partial character string including a predetermined amount of characters, and (b) inputs a next character in the character string as teacher data, and (c) the model predicts the appearance probability for each supposed character string, and (d) regulates a parameter for the function f in the RNN block to decrease a difference between the prediction result and the teacher data, wherein learning is performed by repeatedly executing (a)-(d), wherein, for each subsequent execution of (a)-(d), the computer inputs, as the partial character string, a partial character string obtained by shifting a range of the character string by a predetermined number of characters to obtain a new partial character string overlapping in part with the previous partial character string.

8. The information processing method according to claim 7, wherein the learned model has learned correlation between character strings included in search histories of an electronic apparatus by a plurality of users including users other than the target user.

9. The information processing method according to claim 8, further comprising: transmitting, by the computer, the created word and/or the phrase with a communication module comprising a circuit to the electronic apparatus used by the target user.

10. The information processing method according to claim 7, wherein the learned model has learned search histories by users having an attribute for each of attributes of users, and the method further comprises: creating a word and/or a phrase for learning by the target user on a basis of learning results of search histories of other users having the attribute equal to the attribute of the target user.

11. A non-transitory computer-readable recording medium storing a program to cause a computer of an information processing apparatus storing a learned model having learned correlation between character strings included in a search history of words and/or phrases to execute the learned model to receive information of a search history of words and/or phrases by a target user and create a word and/or a phrase for learning by the target user, wherein: the learned model learns a time series of a plurality of character strings included in the search history, and the program further causes the

computer to input search histories by the target user to the learned model in a time-series manner to output a word and/or a phrase that is not included in the input search histories in a time-series manner; the learned model is a recurrent neural network (RNN) learning correlation between character strings of the time series included in the search history; the learned model includes an input layer, an intermediate layer, and an output layer; the input layer converts a character string input as the search history into a vector quantity, and outputs a character string vector acquired by conversion to the intermediate layer; the intermediate layer is an RNN block which: receives the character string vector from the input layer and receives a previous output of the RNN block of a previous time, inputs the character string vector from the input layer and the previous output of the RNN block to a preset function f , and outputs output of the function f as a current RNN output of a current time, whereby the intermediate layer outputs an RNN output reflecting time-series input change; the output layer converts the RNN output from the intermediate layer into a value of distribution of appearance probability of a character based on the input character string; the program further causes the computer to create the word and/or phrase by combining characters based on the value of distribution of appearance probability of each character, determine whether the created word and/or phrase is included in dictionary content stored in the memory, and control an output device to output the created word and/or phrase determined to be included in the dictionary content stored in the memory, and execute creation of a word and/or phrase again if it is determined that the created word and/or phrase is not included in the dictionary content stored in the memory; and in executing learning, the program causes the computer to (a) input to the learned model a partial character string of the character string based on the search history, the partial character string including a predetermined amount of characters, and (b) input a next character in the character string as teacher data, and (c) the model predicts the appearance probability for each supposed character string, and (d) regulates a parameter for the function f in the RNN block to decrease a difference between the prediction result and the teacher data, wherein learning is performed by repeatedly executing (a)-(d), wherein, for each subsequent execution of (a)-(d), the program causes the computer to input, as the partial character string, a partial character string obtained by shifting a range of the character string by a predetermined number of characters to obtain a new partial character string overlapping in part with the previous partial character string.

12. The recording medium according to claim 11, wherein the learned model has learned correlation between character strings included in search histories of an electronic apparatus by a plurality of users including users other than the target user.

13. The recording medium according to claim 12, wherein the program further causes the computer to transmit the created word and/or the phrase with a communication module comprising a circuit to the electronic apparatus used by the target user.

14. The recording medium according to claim 11, wherein the learned model has learned search histories by users having an attribute for each of attributes of users, and the program further causes the computer to create a word and/or a phrase for learning by the target user on a basis of learning results of search histories of other users having the attribute equal to the attribute of the target user.

15. The information processing apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the at least one processor: determines whether or not the created word and/or phrase is a word and/or phrase for which the target user has searched in a past predetermined time period; controls the output device so as to output the created word and/or phrase which has been determined to be included the dictionary content stored in the memory and for which the target user has not searched in the past predetermined time period; and creates a word and/or phrase again if the created word and/or phrase is not included in the dictionary content stored in the memory or is a word and/or phrase for which the target user has searched in the past predetermined time period.

16. The information processing method according to claim 7, further comprising: determining whether or not the created word and/or phrase is a word and/or phrase for which the target user has searched in a past predetermined time period; controlling the output device so as to output the

created word and/or phrase which has been determined to be included the dictionary content stored in the memory and for which the target user has not searched in the past predetermined time period; and creating a word and/or phrase again if the created word and/or phrase is not included in the dictionary content stored in the memory or is a word and/or phrase for which the target user has searched in the past predetermined time period.

17. The recording medium according to claim 12, wherein the program further causes the computer to: determine whether or not the created word and/or phrase is a word and/or phrase for which the target user has searched in a past predetermined time period; control the output device so as to output the created word and/or phrase which has been determined to be included the dictionary content stored in the memory and for which the target user has not searched in the past predetermined time period; and create a word and/or phrase again if the created word and/or phrase is not included in the dictionary content stored in the memory or is a word and/or phrase for which the target user has searched in the past predetermined time period.
